

FAQ How do I increase the permgen size available to Eclipse?

From Eclipsepedia

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If you see `java.lang.OutOfMemoryError: PermGen space` errors, you need to increase the permanent generation space available to Eclipse.

PermGen is the permanent generation of objects in the VM (Class names, internalized strings, objects that will never get garbage-collected). An easy, if somewhat memory-hungry fix is to enlarge the maximum space for these objects by adding

```
eclipse [normal arguments] -vmargs -XX:PermSize=64M -XX:MaxPermSize=128M  
[more VM args]
```

The arguments after `-vmargs` are directly passed to the VM. Run `java -X` for the list of options your VM accepts. Options starting with `-x` are implementation-specific and may not be applicable to all VMs.

You can also put the extra options in [eclipse.ini](#).

Eclipse and Sun VMs on Windows

Eclipse 3.3 supports a new argument to the launcher: `--launcher.XXMaxPermSize`. On Windows, Eclipse 3.3 ships with the following lines in the `eclipse.ini` file:

```
--launcher.XXMaxPermSize  
256m
```

With the above arguments, if the VM being used is a Sun VM and there is not already a `-XX:MaxPermSize=` VM argument, then the launcher will automatically add `-XX:MaxPermSize=256m` to the list of VM arguments being used. The 3.3 launcher is only capable of identifying Sun VMs on Windows.

Note: Eclipse 3.6 and below has a [bug](#) with **Oracle/Sun JDK 1.6.0_21** (July 2010) where the launcher cannot detect a Oracle/Sun VM, and therefore does not use the correct PermGen size. If you are using either of this version, add the `-xx` flag to the `eclipse.ini` as described above.